



PHOTOS BY GUY PETERSON/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Israel kills scores in Beirut barrage

Lebanon is not part of two-week suspension of attacks, U.S. says

BY MOHAMAD EL CHAMAA AND ELLEN FRANCIS

BEIRUT — Israeli forces pounded Beirut on Wednesday, killing scores of people in an aerial barrage that Israel described as its largest in more than a month of war in Lebanon, just after the United States and Iran announced a two-week ceasefire.

The office of Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said that it supported Trump's two-week suspension of attacks on Iran but that the truce would not stop Israel's offensive against Hezbollah, an Iran-backed militant group in Lebanon.

The Lebanese Health Ministry said Israeli strikes killed at least 182 people across the country Wednesday and injured an additional 890 — a preliminary toll. Lebanon's Civil Defense said search-and-rescue teams were working through the night to pull more people from the rubble.

People across Lebanon had hoped the broader truce would also give their country a respite. But within hours of the announcement, loud bangs rocked the capital as airstrikes hit without warning, including near schools, commercial districts and the country's only international airport.

Hospitals issued appeals for blood donations, and the doctors union urged health care workers to rush to medical centers to help treat the wounded. Columns of smoke rose from Beirut and other parts of the country, including the

SEE LEBANON ON A13



FROM TOP: First responders at the site of a Wednesday airstrike in Beirut. An injured girl is carried out of an ambulance after a strike in Nabatieh, Lebanon, on Wednesday. The Israeli military said it hit more than 100 targets in a span of 10 minutes, including in Beirut, the Bekaa Valley and southern Lebanon.

War costs: White House is set to significantly lower funding request. A10

Fragile ceasefire under threat as accusations fly

TEHRAN WARNS IT MAY PULL OUT OF TALKS

Sides far apart on key issues; Hormuz is still snarled

This article is by Sammy Westfall, Natalie Allison, Evan Halper, Susannah George and Tara Copp

JERUSALEM — A two-week agreement to halt U.S.-Israeli attacks on Iran was under threat from multiple directions on Wednesday. Iran accused the United States of violating the ceasefire. Israel carried out widespread strikes in Lebanon. Iran conducted retaliatory attacks in the Persian Gulf region. And traffic in the Strait of Hormuz remained at a standstill.

Iran might withdraw from talks if violations of the ceasefire continued, Iranian parliament speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf said in a statement Wednesday, which detailed apparent breaches of the agreement, including Israeli attacks in Lebanon, a drone intercepted in Iran and what he said was President

Donald Trump's denial of Iran's right to enrich uranium.

Less than 24 hours since Trump announced the ceasefire, its future remains tenuous, with the two sides slated to begin talks in Pakistan on Friday.

After nearly six weeks of fighting that has destabilized the region and upended the global economy, the agreement raised the prospect of respite. But some of the ceasefire's key details remain unclear — and gaps between Washington and Tehran, and their respective 10- and 15-point plans, remain large.

One point of divergence remains the war in Lebanon.

In an initial announcement of the deal Tuesday, Pakistani Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif, who mediated between the sides, said it included Israel's campaign against Hezbollah in Lebanon.

SEE IRAN ON A11

Trump's brinkmanship fuels debate on credibility, morality

BY ISAAC ARNSDORF

During the 2024 presidential campaign, Donald Trump privately told donors about one of his favorite negotiating tactics, recounting at a New York fundraiser in May how he would deter Chinese or Russian aggression by threatening to bomb Beijing or Moscow.

"He thought I was crazy," Trump said of Chinese leader Xi Jinping's response. "He didn't believe me, except 10 percent. And 10 percent is all you need."

The story, which has not been confirmed by Russian or Chinese officials, speaks to how Trump has approached foreign adversaries: using unpredictability and

the threat of catastrophic escalation to gain leverage. In a twist on Richard M. Nixon's "madman theory," Trump has made shocking threats he believes adversaries cannot afford to dismiss; as president, he threatened to pull out of NATO in 2018, raise tariffs in 2025, and take over Greenland earlier this year.

Trump put the tactic to the riskiest test yet with Tuesday's ultimatum that "a whole civilization will die tonight," which yielded a two-week ceasefire in Iran and an assurance that the country's leaders would let oil tankers through the Strait of Hormuz. Supporters said the outcome demonstrated that Trump's

SEE TRUMP ON A11

No quick retreat on prices for fuel, air travel, strawberries

Americans will continue paying more because of higher energy costs.

BY RACHEL LERMAN

American consumers have started to feel their budgets squeezed beyond gas prices from the U.S.-Israeli war in Iran, as energy costs have begun to pressure shipping, transportation, agriculture and airline prices.

With President Donald Trump on Tuesday announcing a suspension of U.S. attacks on Iran for two weeks, the big question is: When will prices come down?

The price of Brent crude oil, a global benchmark, plunged immediately after the announcement. Gas prices are expected to follow.

While gas prices — now \$4.16 per gallon — have been the most visible impact of the conflict, energy prices are also sending jet fuel prices skyrocketing, leading airlines to find ways to make up those costs. Plus, the agricultural sector is under pressure from higher transportation fees and

fertilizer prices.

Here's what to know about price increases as a result of the war.

Gas prices could take months to fall significantly

Early Wednesday morning, the global benchmark of Brent crude oil had fallen more than 15 percent to close to \$92 a barrel, later creeping up to around \$95, but nonetheless a fall that suggests relief at the pump could be coming.

Prices have been up over the past month because the critical Strait of Hormuz, a main thoroughfare for the world's oil supply, has remained effectively closed to marine traffic. The Strait of Hormuz connects the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman.

Gas prices could start to ease somewhat, influenced by falling global prices for crude oil, but significant energy price relief will depend on negotiations progressing and resumed normal levels of shipping through the Strait of Hormuz.

Jeffrey Roach, chief economist for LPL Financial, said there was reason to be optimistic — with some key caveats.

SEE SURCHARGE ON A18

He's cute. He's rare. He's the biggest star of the Masters.

An adorable garden gnome is the golf tournament's hottest souvenir. With rumors of his demise swirling, he may be harder to get than ever.

BY RICK MAESE



MICHAEL MADRID/IMAGN IMAGES

Behold, the 2026 Masters garden gnome, seen this week in Augusta, Georgia, during the final round of the Augusta National Women's Amateur golf tournament. Is it the last?

At the Masters: Unburdened after finally winning a year ago, Rory McIlroy arrives with a new outlook. B7

AUGUSTA, GA. — Before the gates opened and before the sun rose, they were already lined up with a mission.

Lexi Figueredo had arrived at 5:15 a.m. This is her fifth Masters, but it's the first time she came determined to leave with the tournament's most coveted item. When she finally did, almost two hours later, she couldn't stop admiring him.

"Look at this little umbrella," she said, her smile stretching from tee to green. "It is so cool. I felt very inspired."

The most popular figure at these Masters might not be Rory McIlroy, the Northern Irishman now in a green jacket, or Bryson DeChambeau, the bulked-up YouTube star and perennial contender, or even any of the one-name-only legends of yore — Jack, Faldo, Player — who resurface each April like clockwork.

It might instead be the man with the white beard — coffee in one hand, Masters umbrella in the other — standing a hair over 13 inches tall and made of ceramic. And if the rumors are true, this week may mark his final appearance.

Introduced a decade ago with little fanfare, the Masters garden

SEE GNOMES ON A2

IN THE NEWS

Bondi won't testify The Justice Department said the former attorney general won't appear next week for investigations into convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein. A7

Serial killer guilty The Gilgo Beach suspect confessed to graphic crimes, including killing eight women over three decades. A3

THE NATION The EPA chief praised a group for opposing government action on climate change. A3
A Harvard researcher's visa was improperly revoked over frog embryos, a judge ruled. A6

THE WORLD The Pentagon chief declared victory in Iran as the Joint Chiefs chair took a cautious tone. A10
After Israel's 2024 pager attack on Hezbollah, Hungary offered help to Iran. A10

THE ECONOMY Oil prices plunged below \$95 per barrel, and stock markets surged worldwide after the president pulled back from his threat to destroy Iran, with the Dow Jones Industrial Average, the S&P 500 and the Nasdaq all posting large gains. A14

STYLE Donald Trump's dark rhetoric toward Iran eclipses the wonders of the new Space Age. B1

SPORTS Alex Ovechkin says he is waiting until the season is over to decide whether he's calling it a career or returning to play one more year. B7

THE REGION Maryland authorities seized 93 pounds of cocaine in a drug investigation that dismantled a ring with ties to a Mexican cartel. B12

LOCAL LIVING We humans form interspecies relationships with our pets. So why not with trees?

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